

Candoia carinata

Pacific ground boa



Length 28–39 in (70–100 cm)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Terrestrial/Arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location S.E. Asia, New Guinea, Solomon Islands



flat head

Also known as the Pacific boa, this variable snake has 2 distinct subspecies. Shown above is subspecies *paulsoni*, which is thick and short-tailed, ranges in color from red or grayish brown to off-white, and is completely terrestrial. Subspecies *carinata* is more slender with a longer tail, is brown or gray with an off-white patch above the cloaca, and is known to climb. Both subspecies feed on lizards, frogs, and small mammals.

Charina bottae

Rubber boa



Length 14–32 in (35–80 cm)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Burrowing
Status Least concern

Location S.W. Canada, W. USA



The common name of this boa derives from its rubbery feel. The head and tail are both blunt, and may be hard to tell apart, as with the Calabar ground boa (see p.387). Its defensive technique is also similar: when a threatening



blunt head

blunt tail

small, smooth scales

stout body

mammal or bird of prey approaches, the snake coils into a ball and raises its tail as a “false head,” with which it may pretend to strike in order to deflect attack from its real head. However, the rubber boa is neither venomous nor aggressive. It has the typical body features of a burrowing species, and lives a secretive life below ground or under debris, hunting for birds, reptiles, and small mammals in burrows and tree holes. When winter comes, it hibernates for long periods. While mating, the male stimulates the female with his pelvic spurs and coils his tail around hers. Females give birth to 2–8 young at a time; these measure about 6 in (15 cm) in length, and are pinkish or tan.

Lichanura trivirgata

Rosy boa

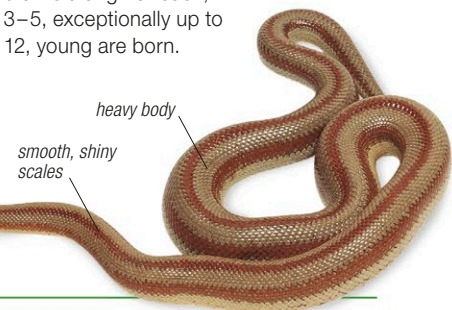


Length 23½–43 in (60–110 cm)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Burrowing
Status Least concern

Location S.W. USA, N.W. Mexico



This snake usually has a pattern of 3 wide, black, brown, reddish brown, or orange stripes down its cream, buff, or gray body; coloration and size vary between its several subspecies. A burrowing snake, it mostly remains hidden beneath rocks and in crevices, foraging there for birds, reptiles, and small mammals. In the colder parts of its range, it hibernates in winter. While mating, the male stimulates the female with his pelvic spurs as he crawls along her back; 3–5, exceptionally up to 12, young are born.



heavy body

smooth, shiny scales

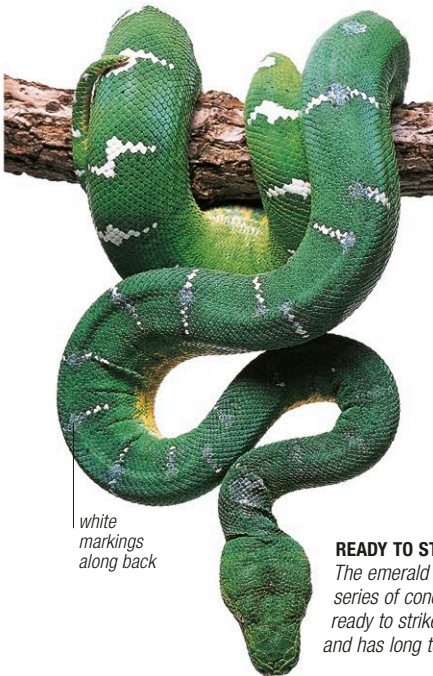
Corallus caninus

Emerald tree boa



Length 5–6½ ft (1.5–2 m)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Least concern

Location N. South America



white markings along back



JUVENILE COLORATION
The emerald tree boa gives birth to 3–15 young each season. They are brick-red, orange, bright red, or yellow, changing to green after about a year.

Like many members of the boa family—particularly the green tree python (see p.392)—this striking South American snake is fully adapted for life off the ground. Its intense green color blends in with the foliage of the rain forests it inhabits, concealing it from predatory birds, while its strong, prehensile tail anchors it firmly to a branch, allowing the boa to lunge out or down to reach a bird or passing mammal. Its eyes have vertical pupils, which help it to sense movement, and it has deep pits in the scales around its mouth, for detecting heat given off by its prey. While mating, the male crawls over the female, and their tails become entwined.

READY TO STRIKE
The emerald boa typically drapes itself around a branch in a series of concentric coils, waiting, with its head hanging down, ready to strike. This boa feeds on small mammals and birds, and has long teeth that help it to grasp its prey firmly.

Corallus hortulanus

Amazon tree boa



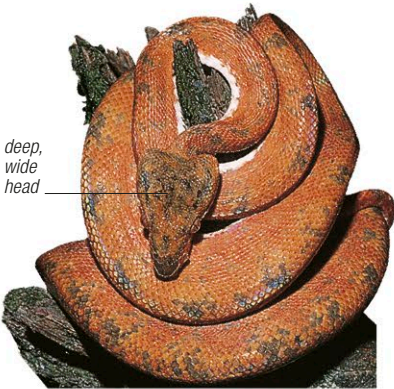
Length 5–6½ ft (1.5–2 m)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Least concern

Location N. and C. South America



A flattened body gives this slender, almost entirely arboreal snake rigidity when reaching out across branches; it often hangs down to snatch lizards and birds from lower branches. The Amazon

tree boa may come down to the ground at night. Coloration varies from brown or grayish with bars or blotches along the back, to plain orange, yellow, or olive.



deep, wide head

Epicrates cenchria

Rainbow boa



Length 3¼–6½ ft (1–2 m)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Partly arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location Central and South America



All subspecies of this boa have smooth, shiny, often highly iridescent scales, with colors varying from dark brown to dark orange. The back has black circles, while

the flanks have light-centered spots. This snake rests by day, actively foraging for birds, lizards, and small mammals at night. Only the southern subspecies hibernate. The size and number of young varies greatly between subspecies.

